

THE TRAILBLAZERS
Infosys co-founder N.R. Narayana Murthy (far left) and other members of the start-up team with their first computer, a Data General MV 8000, acquired in 1983

DIGITAL DOMINOES

- **Rise of software giants like TCS, Infosys etc**
- **Transformation of Bengaluru, the National Capital Region, Hyderabad and Pune into new growth engines**
- **Foundation for knowledge economy**
- **Digital transformation, paving the way for AI technology**
- **Creation of new breed of millionaires through employee stock options**
- **India's IT industry contributed 7% to the country's GDP in FY24, which was 1.2% in FY2000**



"The IT sector was among the first industries to see rapid growth following reforms—in this sense, the industry has been the flagship of India's new economy, instrumental in driving the growth of the 1990s and bringing India to the attention of the world"

— NANDAN NILEKANI
Co-founder & Chairman, Infosys, in his 2008 book Imagining India: Ideas for the New Century

ous peers included Tata Consultancy Services—the industry pioneer set up in 1968—Wipro and HCL.

When opportunity knocked in the form of the Year 2000, or Y2K, bug, Indian companies were ready. The problem was simple but urgent—computer systems globally needed to be formatted to recognise the turn of the millennium from 1999 to 2000. Fixing the Y2K glitch earned India an estimated $2.3 billion in export revenue but, more crucially, Indian software firms got to work with most of the Fortune 500 companies. In no time, India became the back office of the world and by the mid-2000s, the buzzword was Bangalored—a term coined by the West, it meant losing one's job because it had been outsourced to India's software hub of Bangalore, as the city was earlier known. The IT and IT-enabled services (ITeS) industry today employs over five million people and India remains the top outsourcing destination in the world, accounting for 57-58 per cent of global sourcing. ■